

RASPBERRIES

Rubus idaeus

Fresh, juicy raspberries are both tangy and delicious, perfect for eating fresh or using in jams or desserts. Since they are happy to grow in large containers, they can be accommodated in almost any garden. There are two main types of raspberry: summer-fruiting and fall-fruiting, and for pruning purposes it is important to keep the two types separate—summer types fruit on the previous year's canes, and fall types on new growth.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

PLANTING

Raspberry plants are supplied as canes and, although they look very small and neat at this early stage, it won't be long before they become large and trailing, so ensure that you allocate them enough space in your plot or container. Raspberries need a good support system, so prepare this before planting in the ground (see tip box, p.129)—use sturdy posts and horizontal wires, since plants can become quite heavy.

Raspberries need a sheltered location to protect the upright plants from the wind, and full sun. They prefer a pH of between 6 and 6.5, and well-drained, fertile soil, so dig in some well-rotted manure or compost before planting. Plant raspberry



Canes will produce leafy growth in spring.

canes at a depth of about 2–3 in (5–8 cm), and then cut the cane down to a height of approximately 12 in (30 cm). Leave 16 in (40 cm) between each cane and 6 ft (2 m) between rows.

It may be easier to provide the required acidic conditions if you grow the canes in containers, although they will not produce